

Volga Metals Trading — Supply Chain Transparency & Sanctions Exposure Review

Scope:	Corporate structure, beneficial ownership, banking relationships, certificates of origin (desk review — not a fa
Review type:	Enhanced due diligence desk review
Review dates:	2026-01-28 to 2026-01-30
Reviewer:	Meridian Assurance Partners, Trade Compliance Practice
Overall rating:	Unsatisfactory — High Risk (pending disclosure)

Executive Summary

This desk review examined Volga Metals Trading's corporate structure, upstream supplier relationships, and banking arrangements for sanctions and transparency red flags. No direct sanctions list match was found for Volga Metals Trading or its disclosed ownership, but material gaps in upstream ownership transparency and an undisclosed banking relationship warrant enhanced due diligence before the relationship continues at its current volume.

Beneficial Ownership

Corporate registry records for one upstream supplier — a scrap metal aggregator supplying approximately 15% of Volga Metals Trading's sampled volume — show a multi-layer holding company structure registered in a low-transparency jurisdiction, with the ultimate beneficial owner not disclosed in any of the corporate filings reviewed. Repeated requests to Volga Metals Trading for the aggregator's beneficial ownership documentation had not been fulfilled as of the review date.

Banking & Payment Routing

Payment records for two transactions in the past 12 months were routed through a bank not previously disclosed in Volga Metals Trading's on-file banking relationships. Volga Metals Trading has not yet provided an explanation for the change in routing.

Certificates of Origin

Certificates of origin and contract documentation for the sampled shipments not involving the flagged aggregator were complete, internally consistent, and matched the declared countries of origin.

Follow-Up Actions

Action	Severity	Due Date	Status
Obtain full beneficial ownership disclosure for flagged aggregator	Critical	30 days	Open
Clarify undisclosed banking relationship	Major	30 days	Open
Enhanced due diligence monitoring of transaction volume	Major	Ongoing	Open

Conclusion

Recommendation: escalate to compliance/legal for review. Do not suspend the relationship on this review alone, since no direct sanctions match was found, but apply enhanced monitoring and withhold volume increases until beneficial ownership documentation for the flagged aggregator is provided.